

1. When solving an equation, the goal is to _____ the variable.

Two students, James and Joe, were solving the equation $6 - 5(11 - 2x) = 17x$. Their work is shown below for questions 2 – 5.

James' Work	Joe's Work
$6 - 5(11 - 2x) = 17x$	$6 - 5(11 - 2x) = 17x$
$\frac{6 - 5(11 - 2x)}{6} = \frac{17x}{6}$	$6 - 55 + 10x = 17x$
$-5(11 - 2x) = \frac{17x}{6}$	$-49 + 10x = 17x$
	$\underline{-10x \quad -10x}$
$-55 + 10x = \frac{17x}{6}$	$\frac{-49}{7} = \frac{7x}{7}$
$\underline{-10x \quad -10x}$	$-7 = x$
$-55 = -\frac{43x}{6}$	
$\underline{\times 6 \quad \times 6}$	
$-330 = -43x$	
$\frac{330}{43} = x$	

2. Describe the different first steps the students used in solving the equation.
3. Which student made an error?

4. Write a note to the student who made an error explaining the mistake they made.

5. Is 8 a solution to the equation $3(x - 2) + 5 = 23$? Justify your answer mathematically.

For questions 6 – 10, solve each equation and verify the solution using substitution.

6. $-5(2r - 0.3) + 0.5(4r + 3) = -64$

7. $\frac{3m+5}{3} = 9m + 2$

8. $\frac{2}{3} + 13k - 1 = 3k - \frac{5}{3}$

9. $4.1 - 7.2z + 3z = 5.2 + z$

10. $\frac{1}{4}x - 3(x - 2) = -2.25x + 1$